



ICPU1160
Producible

ONLINE COMMUNITIES: *AN UNTAPPED MARKET*

Group 5 - Team AdVance

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1.0 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Online communities are a growing environment for many aspects of marketing exchange, where the promotion of products often aligns with a community founded on shared values and interests (Kim & Chan-Olmsted, 2022). An online community is any virtual space in which people can come together and communicate (Preece, 2010). Within these environments, these environments are often based upon shared enthusiasm for, and knowledge of, a specific consumption activity or related group of activities (Närvänen et al., 2013). Currently, businesses focus on generating content that improves the virality and visibility of their product and digital brand, hoping that the right community will come across their content (Naraine et al., 2021). Fitness communities specifically within the online world demonstrate a universal digital adoption, with 100% of fitness enthusiasts using the internet regularly (Media Culture, 2025). In this, 90% of marketers are actively responding to the data collected from these online communities; however, only 42% of marketers admit they don't know how to use this data effectively (Ben, 2023).

This report contains research and recommendations that aim to assist businesses in effectively targeting the fitness wearables market by leveraging the connection between online communities and shared lifestyles and values. Our approach is rooted in the idea of segmenting audiences through lifestyle segmentation. By grouping consumers according to their lifestyle mindset, businesses can effectively target their audiences and understand why their consumers are interested (Lorenz-Spreen et al., 2018).

Our research has led us to come to three key recommendations:

Recommendation 1

Recommendation one is poised on shifting away from transactional influencer marketing to behaviourally informed community alignment. Instead of selecting influencers based on reach or demographics, use data-driven methods to identify influencers whose online communities genuinely engage with tracking tools. Through taking a community-first approach, this ensures partnerships are grounded in shared values, improving authenticity, trust, and campaign effectiveness.

Recommendation 2

Our second recommendation concerns hashtags as tools for behavioral segmentation to increase accuracy in targeting digital marketing. While traditionally, hashtags are created to render posts visible, little concern has been given to the users, their motivations, and behaviors. We propose segmenting the fitness lifestyle based on user-generated content and co-used hashtags into segments such as runners, lifters, and triathletes. Marketers link their messages with relevant, pre-existing communities by using brand and activity-specific tags, like #WhoopStrain, #TrailRunning, or #RecoveryMode. It would allow brands to connect with much deeper user values and routines, making the messages more resonant and the engagements sharper, most fundamentally, on a culturally relevant level.

Recommendation 3

Our third recommendation concerns leveraging cultural insights from micro-communities to create a larger segment based on shared values, achieving mass appeal and personal resonance. Using data from online communities allows for motivation-first segmentation, ethical insights, and strategic content reuse, marketers can create an impactful campaign. It is recommended to implement this recommendation through a 5-step process: (1) cluster hashtag and influencer data, (2) define market similarities, (3) reverse segmentation for targeting, (4) creative development, and (5) continual data analysis.

2.0 AIMS & RESEARCH DESIGN

2.1 Research question

The aim of this project was to develop a way in which businesses focused on selling fitness wearables can effectively utilise the connection between online communities and lifestyle habits to improve their advertising strategies.

*How can marketers leverage the convergence of behaviours within **online communities** to develop more effective audience segmentation strategies and advertising effectiveness?*

2.2 Research aims

1

To identify the dynamics and influence of online communities, including key trends (e.g., influencers, hashtags), to understand their impact on consumer behaviour.

2

To explore homogeneity across online communities to uncover patterns that inform audience segmentation and engagement strategies.

3

To develop new **evidence-based recommendations** for Producible to enhance segmentation and advertising effectiveness through shared digital experiences.

2.3 Methodology

We adopted the double diamond framework for its flexible, effective approach to problem-solving. Its emphasis on divergence in the Discover and Develop stages fosters creativity and innovation, encouraging exploration of diverse ideas (Makja, 2024).

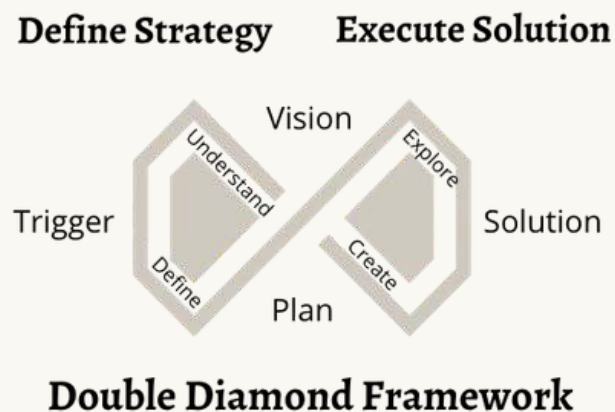


Figure 2.1 - The simplified version of Team AdVance's Double Diamond model

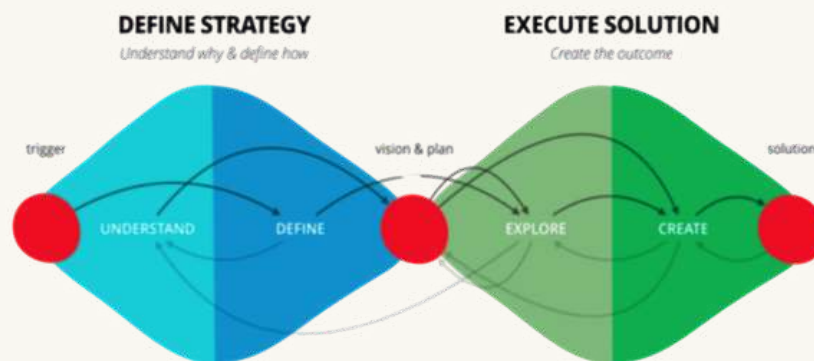


Figure 2.2 - Schneider, J. (2015). The Double Diamond: Strategy + Execution of the Right Solution. Thoughtworks. Retrieved May 30, 2025, from <https://www.thoughtworks.com/en-au/insights/blog/double-diamond>

Our research will combine qualitative and quantitative methodologies (Slevitch, 2011) to gain a comprehensive understanding of both the cultural context and behavioural patterns within digital spaces.

Qualitative Method

Literature review:

A thematic literature review establishes our theoretical framework by examining digital marketing's role in audience segmentation (Kumoji, 2022), online communities and consumer behavior (Lee & Kim, 2011), and influencer as well as hashtag marketing's impact on intergenerational trends (Chen, 2024).



Case Studies:

We will select campaigns featuring shared digital experiences, diverse industries, and measurable engagement (Seawright & Gerring, 2008). Focus areas include influencer and hashtag marketing across platforms, online communities' influence on brand loyalty and identity, and evolving segmentation within digital subcultures.



Quantitative Method

Quantitatively, we conducted a semantic analysis of two fitness-related Reddit communities:

- r/Garmin: A large tech-focused fitness forum (370k members), where we analysed ~11,000 posts from ~9,000 unique users (from March 2020 onward).
- r/Kaylaltsines: A smaller, influencer-centric community (~11k members), where we analysed ~500 posts from ~300 users.

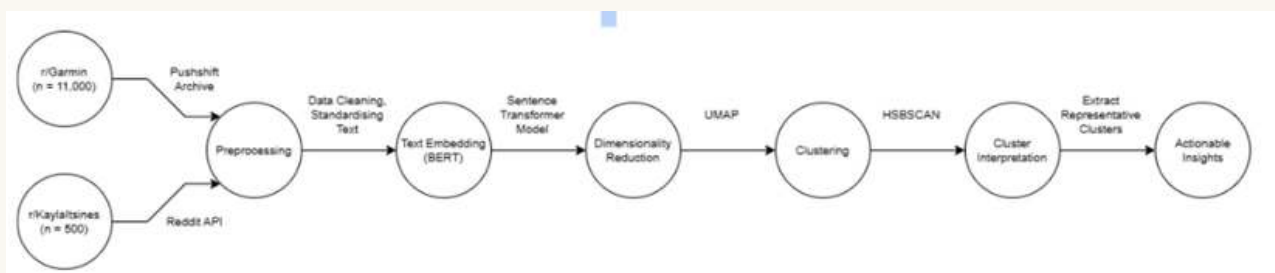


Figure 2.3 - Visual representation of our quantitative analysis process

Using BERT embeddings, we captured the semantic content of each post. We then applied UMAP for dimensionality reduction and HDBSCAN for clustering, uncovering natural audience segments based on shared values, behaviours, and concerns. These clusters provided the foundation for psychographic profiles and informed our three final recommendations.

By combining real user conversations with case study insights, our team translated raw data into interpretable segments and creative personas. While algorithms structured the space, human judgment ensured relevance and strategy alignment. This approach gave our recommendations a clear, data-backed edge while allowing creative flexibility.

3.0

Recommendation 1

3.1 WHAT

An influencer, as defined by Freberg et al. (2011), is a social media figure with the power to shape the attitudes, behaviours, or purchase decisions of their followers. Research suggests that influencer-led communities naturally form around shared values, behaviours, and goals (Martínez-López et al., 2020). As a result, these online communities enable brands to build trust and deliver more personalised, credible campaigns. Therefore, when brands select influencers whose audiences are behaviourally aligned, they're better positioned to meet consumers where they already are engaged and motivated (Belanche et al., 2021).

However, most brands treat influencer marketing as a transactional process (Lammertink, 2025). For instance, fitness tracking wearable companies like Garmin often partner with influencers to showcase features such as heart rate tracking or calorie-burning readings (Sheridan, 2025). These partnerships are often driven by follower count, aesthetic fit, and demographic alignment rather than focused on gaining a deeper understanding of who the influencer's audience actually is, why they engage, or whether they're even interested in the product (Lammertink, 2025). Here, brands often waste budget on influencers who do not possess behaviorally aligned communities and fail to reach audiences effectively (Dwivedi, 2021).

3.2 WHY

Given that the effectiveness of influencer marketing relies heavily on the audience's psychological involvement with the influencer and whether the promoted product fits naturally into the values and habits shared by that community (Belanche et al., 2021), we recommend a shift away from traditional influencer marketing strategies toward a more strategic, behaviourally informed model of community-based alignment. This recommendation is grounded in the need for brands to begin by identifying and understanding authentic audience communities before selecting influencers.

Traditional Approach	Recommended Approach
Select influencer based on: • Number of Followers • Aesthetic fit • Demographic alignment	Step 1: Start with Behaviour, Not Followers — Spot Community Leaders Identify potential influencers who appear to lead niche lifestyle communities. E.g. running, recovery, sleep hacking
Assumes follower interest based on influencer popularity	Step 2: Use Data to Understand the Community Perform sentiment/behavioural deep dive of data derived from subreddits or other forum sources into their follower community. Criteria: • Why do followers engage? • What are their tracking goals?
Broad and often mismatched to product category	Step 3: Determine Audience Relevance- Filtering Process Identify relevant influencer communities by filtering through the data identifying the influencers who have a community that are interested in trackers vs the influencers who have communities that don't seem interested. Map these behaviors/ lifestyle-based communities around influencer content and follower interactions. • Do these customers want what you're selling? • Does this influencer therefore have the right community to sell? • Do they want trackers (i.e. would they be interested in a garmin/apple watch)?
Influencer delivers generic brand messaging or one-off endorsements	Step 4: Co-Create with the Right Voice Co-create content with influencers that mirrors real-world use cases and motivations.

Figure 3.1 - Comparison of Traditional Influencer Marketing Approach vs Recommended Approach

3.3 HOW

We recommend starting by identifying creators who appear to lead a niche lifestyle community such as runners, lifters, or sleep hackers and then using data to understand whether the community is genuinely aligned with tracking-focused products to move beyond surface-level reach and focus on relevance and resonance. For instance, for the purpose of this report we have identified two influencers who lead distinct fitness-oriented communities to represent how the overall strategy can be executed. Kayla Itsines is widely associated with high-intensity strength and cardio training, while Kayla Jeter promotes a more holistic model of athleticism and functional fitness (Gross, 2018; Lang, 2024). Following their identification as potential lifestyle leaders, we collected user-generated data from Reddit, focusing on posts and comments within their communities, and then fed them into a machine-learning model.

This model, known as a sentence transformer, can analyse the semantic information within a piece of text, understanding what it means, not just what it says. Therefore, by analysing the output we can gauge the tone, intensity, and thematic focus of follower discussions (Bordoloi & Biswas, 2023). This approach enables us to assess not only the level of positive engagement but also the presence of specific interests, such as workout tracking, to determine whether a creator's audience is genuinely aligned with fitness tracking products. For example, applying this analysis revealed that followers of Kayla Jeter showed little to no engagement with topics related to wearable fitness trackers. In contrast, keyword analysis of user-generated content related to Kayla Itsines uncovered frequent mentions of wearable devices, training logs, and performance metrics.

Interested in Tracking?	Keyword Extraction	Sentiment Analysis	Insight
Tracking Interest	"What's the best way to track BBG on Apple Watch?"	Positive	Followers are actively using and seeking wearable and app-based tracking tools.
Syncing Frustrations	"It's annoying that I have to manually track..." "Has anyone synced Samsung watch with Sweat app?"	Negative	Pain points around device integration highlight opportunity for seamless tracking solutions.
Progress Tracking	"Finally completed week 8 and my rings are closed!"	Positive	Celebrating tracked milestones shows strong community engagement with wearable progress features.

Figure 3.2 - Data Analysis of Kayla Itsine's Community Conversations

Figure 3.2 suggests that her community demonstrates a stronger alignment with workout tracking tools, making her a more relevant candidate for partnerships involving fitness tracking products. Ultimately, this methodology enables the mapping of distinct, lifestyle-based communities around influencer content and follower engagement patterns. The critical question it raises is whether these followers demonstrate a clear interest in the product category. If the answer is affirmative, the influencer in question possesses a community that can be meaningfully activated.

Once the appropriate influencer has been identified through alignment between the community's characteristics and the product offering, brands can move beyond traditional models of generic brand messaging or one-off endorsements (Lammertink, 2025). Instead, a more effective approach involves collaborating with influencers to co-create content that directly reflects the goals, values, and behavioural tendencies of their audience. For example, the data analysis revealed that while followers within Kayla Itsines' fitness community actively use wearable and app-based tracking tools, a significant unmet need lies in guidance on optimising the integration of these devices with structured workout programs.



By addressing this pain point through collaborative content development, brands can create material that not only provides functional utility, such as technical guidance and workout optimisation, but also connects emotionally with users' intrinsic motivations, including self-improvement, progress tracking, and the satisfaction of communal achievement. This approach aligns with Filali-Boissy et al. (2025), who emphasise that content grounded in the specific needs and experiences of a community fosters authenticity, strengthens trust, and deepens consumer-brand relationships. As a result, co-created content encourages greater audience engagement and drives the adoption of wearable fitness technologies in ways that feel personally relevant rather than commercially driven. Ultimately, by embedding brand messaging within the rhythms and realities of the influencer's community, this strategy ensures behavioural resonance and enhances the long-term impact of marketing efforts.

This approach moves beyond demographic and aesthetic alignment to focus on real psychological and behavioural relevance, enabling brands to target communities genuinely interested in a brand's products and to experience greater campaign receptivity (Osei-Frimpong et al., 2023). By leveraging data-driven audience validation and then co-creating content that reflects community motivations, brands can transition from transactional influencer marketing to authentic, long-term community integration, resulting in deeper engagement, enhanced trust, and sustained brand loyalty in the fitness tracking market.

4.0

Recommendation 2

4.1 WHAT

In contemporary digital media, hashtags have evolved from mere labels for content or indicators of trending topics into powerful, automated audience segmentation tools that serve as technical classifiers and signals of social identity (Kwon & Ha, 2023). Zappavigna (2015) permits "emergent bonding" through searchable themes, enabling users to associate with others who share similar aims, values, or activities without requiring direct interaction. Thus, anything previously strictly demarcated via demographic variables is now possible through behavior and interests, forming powerful means to identify and target micro-communities online. The latter opens new marketing opportunities, from demographic targeting to behavioral segmentation based on community insights.

That said, hashtags stay underused. Most brands use hashtags more as 'megaphones' than 'microscopes,' driven primarily by reach and visibility rather than any contextual understanding of the culture or meaning behind the hashtags they use (Usadolo, 2024). From a marketing perspective, such "vanity metrics" are celebrated —reach and likes — even when there is no real penetration into behavioral insights or community resonance; otherwise, they merely render hashtags into promotional tools. Not so; the real worth of the hashtag can be found in the ways it propagates among bodies mobilized by a sense of identity, a fact well-noted by scholars such as Barron (2023) and Caleffi (2015).



Figure 4.1 - Examples of news reporting that misuse the hashtag without understanding its meaning



In this regard, Naraine et al. (2019) identify hashtags as anchors that can create "third places," digital spaces where communities emerge from shared interests. When used strategically, hashtags serve the purposive marketing task of finding brands within self-finding communities rather than imposing externally created narratives from outside. Visibility for authentic community membership through branded hashtags, thereby eliciting strong emotional engagement with the brand's further developments. Therefore, an effective hashtag strategy will not emerge from trend-chasing but from a community's listening and behavioral clustering. Ultimately, hashtags should be understood not as tools for amplification but as cultural markers that reflect consumer identity and intent. Thus, by strategically using advanced hashtags based on behavioral clustering and community listening, they set the path for more ethical, practical, and relevant marketing communications.

4.2 WHY

WHOOP, a brand of performance wearables focused on physiological tracking, can be cited as an example of both the promise and the pitfalls of hashtag strategy. The company's hashtag, #WhoopStrain, encourages users to share their recovery scores, strain metrics, and sleep data. On the surface, this generates product visibility and promotes the device's technical features. However, the implementation reveals a shortcoming: WHOOP uses the hashtag as a product-centric promotional tool rather than a mechanism to understand or engage distinct user segments.

Despite strong participation across platforms, there is no nuanced behavioral application of the hashtag for WHOOP. Our sentiment analysis of Reddit communities, such as r/Running, r/Triathlon, and r/Garmin, revealed distinct patterns of engagement among various user groups, such as triathletes, swimmers, runners, and weight trainers, each discussing WHOOP within the context of their specific goals and routines.



A further analysis using social listening tools on r/Whoop reveals that it is linked to other lifestyle-related hashtags. It is worth noting that those at WHOOP currently use monolithic-type hashtags, and this is where the performance data is dumped without consideration for motivation and meaning, given the wide variety of users. WHOOP has undertaken a broad, undifferentiated play; it addresses all users in general but has not targeted any particular user segment. The hashtag then acts more like an index, and nothing resonates with any insight or identity concerning this community of users at WHOOP.

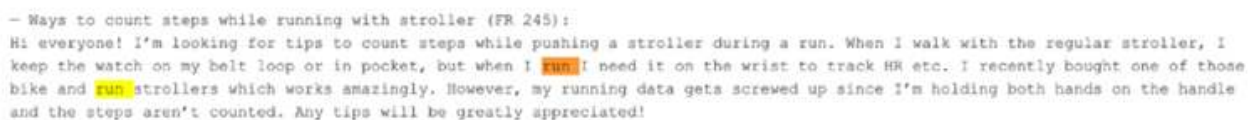
A more effective approach would incorporate layered hashtag strategies that combine branded terms, such as #WhoopStrain, with behavioral and lifestyle-specific tags, like #TrailRunning, #RecoveryMode, or #StrengthTraining. From there, discoverability within relevant subcultures would increase, allowing for a more organic embedding of WHOOP into user conversations. It means the brand would not have to come off as referring to its product's specific features in the context of personal fitness journeys. The #WhoopStrain is used more as a data-tracking tag than a cultural identifier. Without emotional and social anchoring, the brand risks being perceived as an alien entity in the lives of its users.

A strategic pivot would involve using community insights to develop segmented, lifestyle-specific content that reflects the motivations of key user groups. Campaigns anchored in hashtags like #WhoopRun or #WhoopLift could target runners and strength trainers with messaging tailored to their routines and values. This transition, from visibility-focused promotion to value-based engagement, would enable WHOOP to deepen brand integration within its user communities and drive more meaningful, sustainable loyalty.

4.3 HOW

The unique ability the hashtag holds through playing a dual role as an “indicator of both the topic of the content and the membership of a community” (Kwon & Ha, 2022, 79) enables it to function as an automatic segmentation tool. In order to figure out these segments, we recommend processing the information regarding a specific fitness wearable within a social media database, where they can use keyword analysis and topic modelling to categorise their consumers into fitness lifestyle-oriented segments.

For example, we applied this process of sentiment analysis when attempting to segment the lifestyles of Garmin users. To do this, we utilised a machine learning model and ran user-generated data from Reddit that involved the use of their hashtag, the ‘r/’ function. Searching ‘r/Garmin’, we then began the process of key topic modelling through searching for user-generated posts that involved using the Garmin for a specific fitness activity. In doing so, we identified multiple different lifestyle uses for the Garmin device, including running, cycling, swimming, yoga, walking (hiking), triathletes and weight training.



– Ways to count steps while running with stroller (FR 245):
Hi everyone! I'm looking for tips to count steps while pushing a stroller during a run. When I walk with the regular stroller, I keep the watch on my belt loop or in pocket, but when I **run** I need it on the wrist to track HR etc. I recently bought one of those bike and **run** strollers which works amazingly. However, my running data gets screwed up since I'm holding both hands on the handle and the steps aren't counted. Any tips will be greatly appreciated!

Figure 4.2 - Examples of reddit post regarding garmin users

From here, we recommend that Garmin create advertisements that include fitness lifestyle-specific hashtags within their captions, such as #swimming or #running, in combination with the brand-specific hashtag.

These are some examples of how this can be implemented for fitness wearables WHOOP and Garmin:

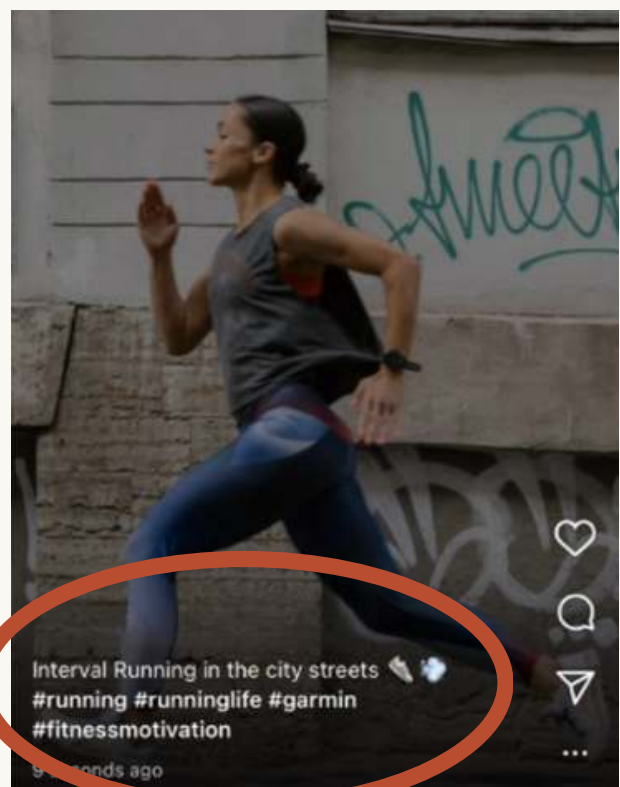
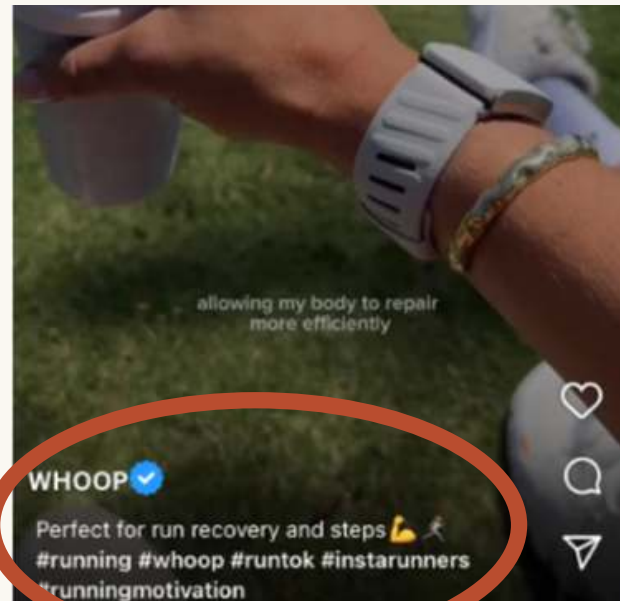


Figure 4.3 - Examples of how to implement more effectively



Here, consumers who are into running or swimming will be exposed to specific advertisements targeted to their interests, and can view the benefits and usage of the product concerning their activity.

How this differentiates from regular hashtag usage is through the utilisation of the hashtag itself. The current usage of the hashtag within businesses is to increase the visibility of their product through virality (Kumar et al., 2022). Hashtags used in this way attempt to stimulate attention and gain the interest of their viewers through the use of promotional content (Tjandra et al., 2023). However, this approach does not consider the fact that businesses may not reach their intended target market for their product. Prioritising virality and visibility of a product results in aiming to reach the intended target market leaving businesses with very little understanding of who is engaging with their advertisements and why.

Our approach is then unique and differentiates from regular hashtag usage as it manages to not only segment but also identify distinct fitness lifestyle groups based on hashtag clusters. Here, businesses gain a clear understanding of their audience and product users, enabling them to more effectively understand why consumers engage with their product (Plummer, 1974). In this way, businesses are then able to create fitness lifestyle-related advertisements for their products that are relevant to a certain fitness community, improving the effectiveness of their advertising strategies.

5.0

Recommendation 3

5.1 WHAT

Influencers and hashtags create close-knit communities that naturally segment audiences (Belanche et al., 2021). The insights from recommendations 1 and 2 provide a foundation for an integrated understanding of specific communities, although targeting is limited to particular online segments. In recommendation 3, we broaden this concept by transitioning from targeting isolated communities to achieving mass resonance through shared values within multiple online communities. Figure 5.1 details how Recommendation 3 builds off of Recommendations 1 and 2.

Repeat	Recommendation 1 Targeted Influencer Strategy	Recommendation 2 Targeted Hashtag Strategy
	Start with an influencers who appears to lead niche lifestyle communities (e.g. running)	Start with the # (e.g. #Garmin)
	Analyse their community (behavioural deep dive e.g. tracking motivations)	Analyse who use the # and in what context
	Identify relevant influencer communities (e.g. filter through what influencer communities are interested)	Identify the fitness community (e.g. runners, lifters)
Recommendation 3 Mass marketing through Influencer x Hashtag Strategy	Spot shared values, habits and behaviours across multiple influencer & # communities	
	Form lifestyle/behavioural segment based on commonalities	
	Deliver a campaign that scales messaging and mass-markets an offering	

Figure 5.1 - Table of Recommendation 3 in Combination with Recommendations 1 and 2

Recommendation 3 uses shared cultural insights from online micro-communities to create scalable marketing campaigns. It emphasizes balancing personal relevance with mass appeal by utilizing a motivation-first approach that merges insights from various communities.

5.2 WHY

This recommendation demonstrates how brands can create a meaningful impact by grounding their campaigns in shared cultural values derived from distinct communities, ensuring relevance and authenticity. Our idea not only expands the reach of the audience but also builds on the concept of connecting to the deeply held values that social media users have in common. This strategy is built on micro-segmentation through social listening, which delves into cultural nuances and behavioral drivers beyond basic demographics. Through motivation-first segmentation, ethical insights, and strategic content reuse, marketers can create a meaningful, scalable impact.

5.3 HOW

Step 1: Cluster Hashtag and Influencer Data	Identify Shared Values Across Communities
Step 2: Define Market Similarities	Develop Emotionally and Behaviorally Informed Profiles
Step 3. Reverse Segmentation for Targeting	Values-based segmentation for Ethical Targeting
Step 4. Creative Development	Craft Messaging That Resonates Across Communities
Step 5. Data Analysis	Measure Engagement and Refine Strategies

Figure 5.2 - Steps for Implementation of Recommendation 3

Refer to Figure 5.2 for an overview of the following steps to implement Recommendation 3. Our first step is analyzing individual online communities, which reveals distinct micro-segments. **Step 1** requires gathering data to perform a cluster analysis and investigate shared traits. We analyzed influencers' followers like Kayla Itsines or the #Garmin community, and shared traits emerged, such as movement, support, and digital connection, seen in Figure (below). This step combines the power influencers and online communities identified by hashtags to shape purchasing behaviors. (Freberg et al., 2011 as cited in Campbell, 2023) (Kim et al., 2022) (Haenlein et al., 2020 as cited in Kim et al., 2022)

The second step is to define market similarities. **Step 2** takes the data from the cluster analysis and turns it into meaningful insights about the shared values and behaviors of segments. Mark Ritson highlights the importance of understanding these clusters' identities to inform marketing strategies (Ritson, 2023). When creating profiles of the shared traits both Kayla Itsines and #Running communities have in common, we created a larger segment called: “Connected Optimisers.” Figure 5.3 exemplifies how we made this segment.

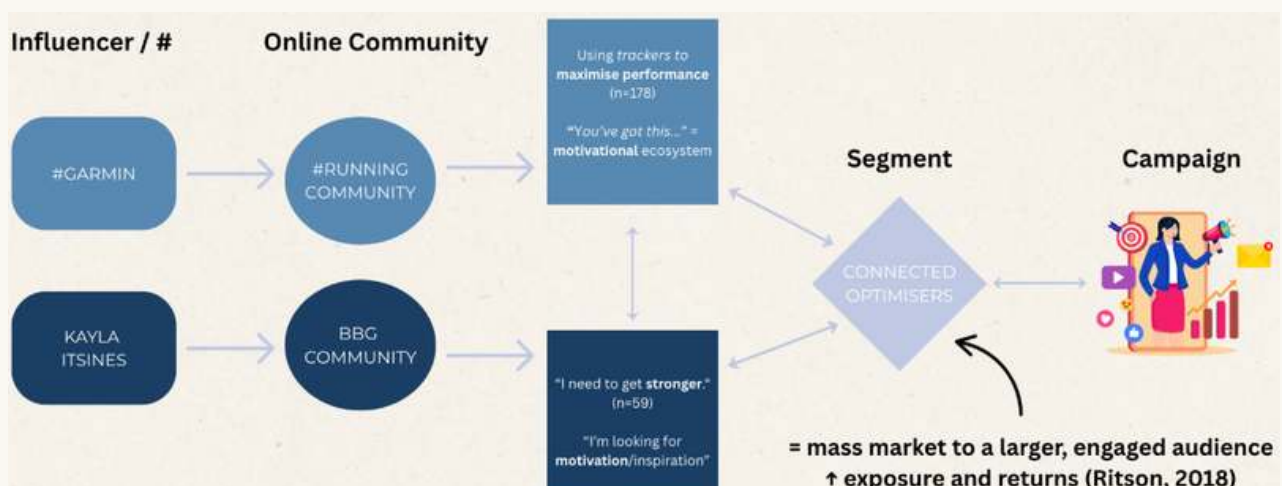


Figure 5.3 - Diagram of Online Communities and the “Connected Optimisers” Segmentation Ideology



We created these clusters by collecting organic user-generated real-time data, and then feeding them into a sentence transformer, a machine-learning model that analyses and encodes the semantic information of a piece of text. We then used a clustering algorithm to organically discover user segments within the community. Finally, for the interpretation of our clusters, we pulled several representative posts from each cluster for manual analysis.

Step 3 implements reverse segmentation. This starts small, with niche online communities, and gathers ethical insights to create a values-based targeting strategy. Reverse segmentation focuses on what makes distinct groups similar, rather than oversimplifying distinct groups. The approach advocates for a reverse-funnel strategy, starting with niche communities to foster mass engagement. This method, as discussed by Funk, involves analyzing highly engaged smaller communities first (Funk, 1965-c2011). Building on Recommendations 1 and 2, we conduct deep analyses of individual communities to inform targeted strategies.

The core of our deep analysis is the sentence transformer, a machine-learning model that can understand the semantic information of a piece of text, meaning it can understand what it means, not just what it says. It then encodes this information in a high-dimensional vector, which we performed our clustering on. However, currently, no algorithm or model can understand human language better than humans can. Therefore, our final step was to extract representative samples from the clusters for manual human analysis.

Step 4 uses this highly detailed, precise target market to begin creative development of the campaign that will resonate deeply with the strongly held beliefs and values of a large audience. Messaging can be amplified to resonate across communities when insights are gathered before meaningful messages are created. During this phase, we created our campaign to include a story of movement and connection through social media. We used the idea of optimisation to focus on how the Garmin watch not only helps track your activities, but can be a social motivator in an online community. We implemented the idea of being a part of the fitspiration online community, following influencers for motivation, and created the hashtag #CONNECTCOMMIT because branded hashtags foster community attachment. (Mogull et al., 2023)

As a result, we created an example campaign of a video advertisement for Garmin aimed at Connected Optimizers, which can be adapted to resonate with broader audiences by emphasizing themes like empowerment and progress tracking, while still aligning with community norms. This strategy respects the diversity within and across segments, driving mass engagement and fostering long-term brand affinity anchored in community support and personal growth. Our campaign highlights the personal relevance of fitness tracking while gaining mass appeal through the popular ideas of empowerment and growth.

The fifth step involves data analysis to measure the effectiveness of these campaigns. Marketers should invest in data analysis technology and skilled professionals to interpret engagement and responses within online communities. To put Step 5 into practice, we can reuse our machine-learning-based analysis method by using a wide range of pre-trained models that can be easily adapted to different campaigns, audiences, or goals. This plug-and-play approach allows us to apply the same framework across various communities to see how messaging is received, which segments are most engaged, and where strategy adjustments can improve impact. These insights help marketers refine their approach while staying aligned with community values, boosting both authenticity and long-term engagement.

6.0

Conclusion and Next Steps

This report addresses an important current issue in advertising, highlighting how brands have yet to tap into the behavioural patterns and shared values characteristic of online communities. Our research adds that broad, demos-based targeting often misapprehends the complex social dynamics of digital fitness audiences, leading to under-engagement and unfair resource allocation.

Our three interconnected recommendations form the foundation of this new approach. Together, these recommendations offer a strategic model for audience targeting that prioritises cultural relevance and behavioural insight. Our recommendations enable brands to increase message resonance, foster deeper audience trust, and cultivate long-term brand loyalty. For secondary stakeholders such as fitness influencers, platform communities, and wearable technology companies, this approach promotes authentic brand partnerships, enhances audience engagement, and drives more meaningful product adoption.

To move from theory to practice, the following steps should involve implementing robust digital listening systems, integrating behavioural analytics into campaign planning, and piloting activations within clearly defined online community segments. It harbours the promise of genuine relationships for brands, greater marketing efficiency, and longer-term brand equity. However, there are key limitations. High-quality data generation lacks real user-level costs, yet building valuable behavioural models demands time, expertise, and ethical care. Additionally, consumer behaviour in digital communities is volatile and rapidly changing, so insights can quickly become outdated without ongoing monitoring and campaign refinement.

Nonetheless, by embracing nuance over generalisation, and cultural insight over assumption, this report proves brands can move beyond outdated generational myths and instead build deeper, more authentic connections grounded in shared values and real digital behaviours.

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AI Declaration

We acknowledge that we have used artificial intelligence (AI) tools to assist in the development of this assignment. The AI tools were used in a supportive capacity only, and we have critically engaged with and edited all generated content to ensure originality, relevance, and alignment with the assignment requirements.

Specifically, AI assistance was used for the following purposes: Structuring the report, grammar checking and refining wording to meet the word count.

We confirm that:

- All sources of AI-generated content have been properly reviewed and edited by us.
- The final submission reflects our own understanding and work.
- We take full responsibility for the academic integrity and authenticity of this assignment.
- Tool(s) used: ChatGPT (OpenAI)